

All in one: On the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana scheme

Agriculture needs more **public spending**, not just one **umbrella scheme**

The Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY), a scheme approved by the Union Cabinet, **is** to be implemented through the **convergence** of 36 **existing** schemes across 11 Departments. According to Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, the scheme **seeks** to **address** the “**disparities in productivity**” between States, and even among districts within a State. The Centre’s **pet schemes** such as the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) and the PM Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) as well as relevant State schemes, to be identified by the District Dhan Dhaanya Samitis, **will** be **subsumed** in the PMDDKY. Local **partnerships** with the private sector **will** also be promoted under the **proposed** scheme, which will begin in October during the rabi crop season. The scheme is to get an annual **outlay** of ₹24,000 crore for six years. Modelled on NITI Aayog’s Aspirational Districts Programme, the Centre will identify 100 districts based on low productivity and cropping **intensity** and less credit **disbursement**. The hope is that the scheme will **result in** higher productivity, value addition in agriculture and **allied** sectors, local **livelihood** creation, **leading to** increased domestic production and **self-reliance**. This convergence of schemes must be viewed in the background of decreasing public spending on agriculture. **The Parliamentary Standing Committee** on Agriculture, in the latest report on Demands for **Grants**, **had** observed a continuous decline, from 3.53% in 2021-22 to 3.14% (2022-23), 2.57% (2023-24), 2.54% (2024-25) and 2.51% (2025-26), of the **allocations** for agriculture as a percentage of total Central Plan outlay.

This **aggregation** of all schemes under one umbrella **suggests** that the Government wants **uniformity** in running the welfare, financial and technical schemes in the agriculture sector. It is **keen** to add States’ measures too in the new scheme. **It remains to be seen** how effective such uniformity will be on the ground as further decrease in public investment in agriculture could be **disastrous**. Private-public partnerships should be **for the larger good** of self-reliance, particularly in the production of foodgrains, edible oil and pulses. The **progress** of area coverage under kharif crops, released last week, **points to** a decrease in the **sowing** of oil seeds and popular pulses. Though it **promotes** national uniformity, it is welcome that the new scheme will function based on ‘District Plans’ that will be **aligned** to the national goals of crop **diversification**, conservation of water and soil health, **self-sufficiency** in agriculture and allied sectors. For the PMDDKY, the Centre will **monitor** 117 key indicators of progress on a monthly basis. But to make it more participatory, States, local self governments, primary agriculture cooperative societies, agriculture universities and organisations of farmers and traders must be involved in this process.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.
- **Self-sufficiency** (noun) – the quality or condition of being self-sufficient. स्वतंत्रता

Vocabulary

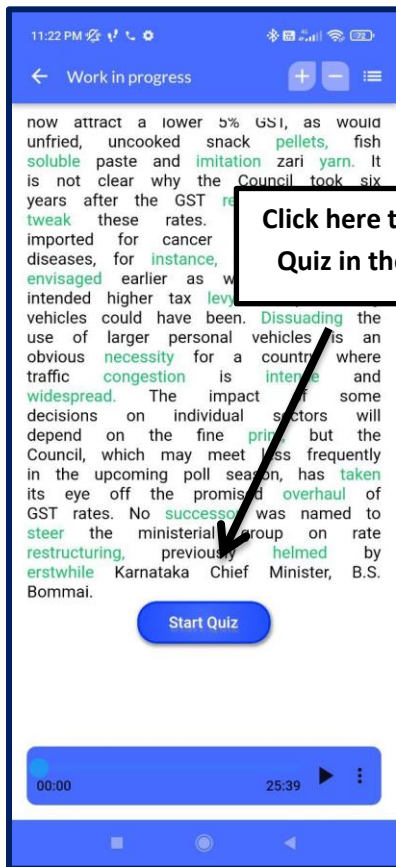
1. **Public spending** (noun) – the money the government spends on buying goods and providing services सरकारी खर्च
2. **Umbrella scheme** (noun) – when a group of plans or scheme is being merged into a single scheme, then we can call it umbrella scheme समग्र योजना
3. **Convergence** (noun) – merging, integration, unification, coming together, amalgamation एकीकरण
4. **Existing** (adjective) – current, present, prevailing, in effect, operative वर्तमान
5. **Seek** (verb) – aim, strive, pursue, endeavour, attempt प्रयास करना
6. **Address** (verb) – tackle, resolve, confront, deal with, handle समाधान करना
7. **Disparity** (noun) – inequality, imbalance, gap, divergence, variation असमानता
8. **Productivity** (noun) – output, efficiency, yield, performance, production क्षमता
9. **Pet** (noun modifier) – favorite, preferred, key, chosen, flagship पसंदीदा
10. **Subsume** (in) (verb) – include, absorb, incorporate, merge, assimilate में समाहित करना
11. **Proposed** (adjective) – suggested, planned, projected, intended, recommended प्रस्तावित
12. **Outlay** (noun) – expenditure, allocation, spending, budget, disbursement खर्च
13. **Intensity** (noun) – severity, force, magnitude, strength, concentration तीव्रता
14. **Disbursement** (noun) – payment, release, spending, outflow, allocation भुगतान
15. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – cause, lead to, bring about, produce, generate परिणाम देना
16. **Allied** (adjective) – related, connected, associated, linked, affiliated सम्बद्ध
17. **Livelihood** (noun) – income, sustenance, means of living, earnings, occupation आजीविका
18. **Lead (to)** (verb) – result in, bring about, contribute to, cause, trigger का कारण बनना
19. **Self-reliance** (noun) – independence, autonomy, self-sufficiency, self-support, self-dependence आत्मनिर्भरता
20. **Grant** (noun) – funding, subsidy, allowance, aid, contribution अनुदान
21. **Allocation** (noun) – distribution, allotment, assignment, share, apportionment आवंटन

22. **Aggregation** (noun) – collection, accumulation, compilation, grouping, cluster समेकन
of all, for common good, for the collective welfare व्यापक भलाई के लिए
23. **Uniformity** (noun) – consistency, standardization, sameness, regularity, homogeneity एकरूपता
24. **Keen** (to) (adjective) – eager, enthusiastic, interested, determined, inclined उत्सुक
25. **It remains to be seen** (phrase) – uncertain, unclear, still in doubt, questionable, time will tell अभी देखना बाकी है
26. **Disastrous** (adjective) – catastrophic, ruinous, damaging, calamitous, devastating विनाशकारी
27. **For the larger good** (phrase) – for public welfare, in general interest, for the benefit
28. **Point to** (phrasal verb) – indicate, suggest, highlight, reveal, signify संकेत करना
29. **Sowing** (noun) – planting, seeding, cultivation, germination, propagation बुआई
30. **Promote** (verb) – encourage, boost, advance, support, foster बढ़ावा देना
31. **Align** (to) (verb) – match, coordinate, adapt, conform, integrate मेल करना
32. **Diversification** (noun) – variety, expansion, differentiation, broadening, variation विविधीकरण
33. **Monitor** (verb) – track, observe, supervise, watch, oversee निगरानी रखना

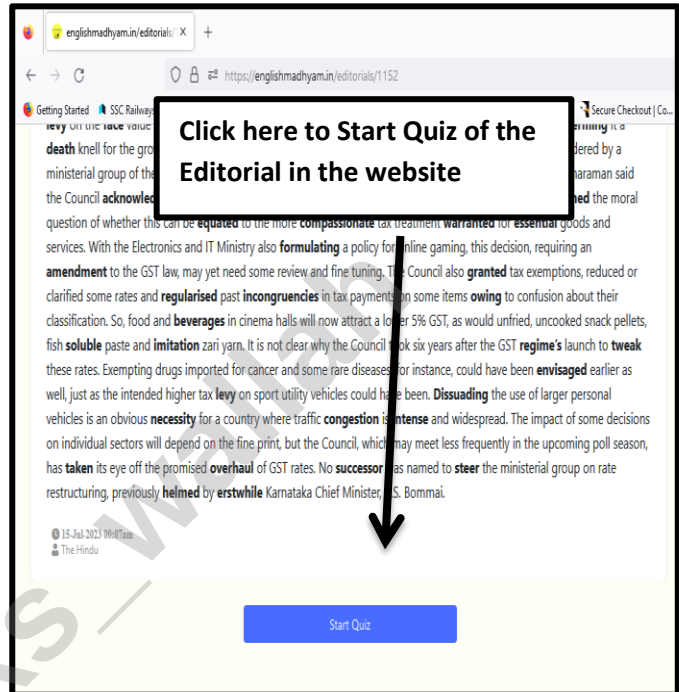
Summary of the Editorial

1. **PMDDKY Launch:** The *Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY)* is a newly approved scheme aiming to integrate 36 existing agricultural schemes across 11 departments.
2. **Main Objective:** It seeks to reduce *productivity disparities* across States and districts in India.
3. **Scheme Integration:** Central flagship schemes like *PM-KISAN* and *PM Fasal Bima Yojana*, along with selected State schemes, will be merged into PMDDKY.
4. **District Focus:** 100 districts with low productivity, cropping intensity, and poor credit disbursement will be prioritized.
5. **Implementation Model:** The scheme is inspired by the *Aspirational Districts Programme* of NITI Aayog.
6. **Funding:** It is allocated an annual budget of ₹24,000 crore for six years, starting from the *rabi season in October*.
7. **Public-Private Partnerships:** PMDDKY aims to foster partnerships with the *private sector* to support local development.
8. **Expected Outcomes:** The scheme aims for *higher agricultural productivity, value addition, local livelihood generation, and self-reliance*.
9. **Declining Public Spending:** The editorial notes a steady fall in agriculture's share of the Central Plan outlay—from 3.53% in 2021-22 to 2.51% in 2025-26.
10. **Concerns on Uniformity:** Centralizing all schemes could risk inefficiency or poor adaptability to local needs if not executed carefully.
11. **Risks of Reduced Investment:** The editorial warns that *reduced public investment* in agriculture could have negative long-term effects.
12. **Crop Sowing Trends:** Recent kharif crop data show a worrying *decline in oilseed and pulse sowing*, stressing the need for strategic focus.
13. **District-Level Customization:** Though centrally driven, PMDDKY will adopt *district-specific plans* aligned with national agricultural goals.
14. **Key Monitoring Mechanism:** The Centre will track *117 key indicators monthly* to measure the scheme's progress.
15. **Inclusive Participation Needed:** For effective implementation, involvement of *States, local governments, farmer groups, cooperatives, and agri-universities* is essential.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



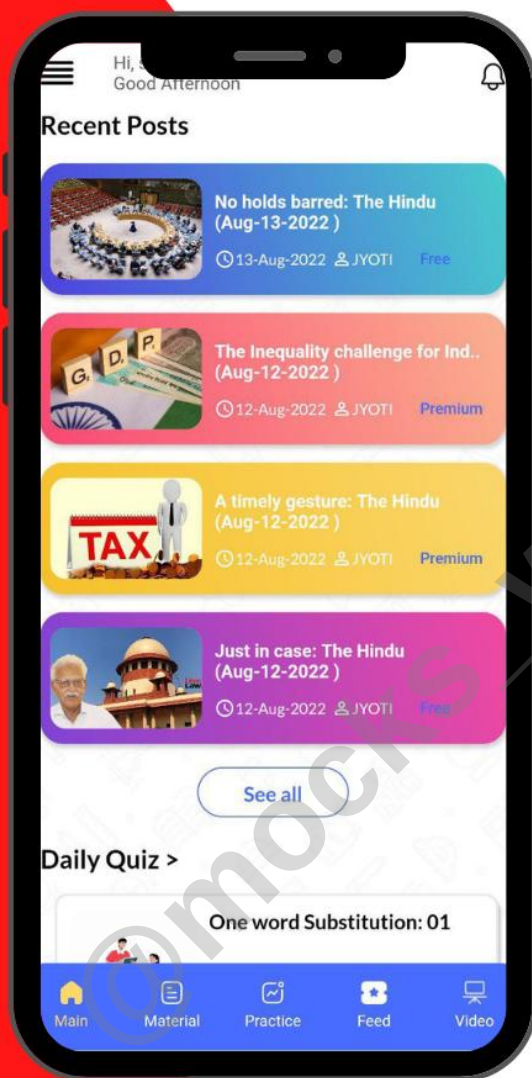
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